

March 4, 1945

Julius Stulman, Esq.,

My dear Mr. Stulman:

On behalf of the Merkos L'Yayonei Chinuch, and in my own name, I wish to thank you for your generous contribution. It was particularly timely, since it helped to relieve the financial stringency of the Merkos. It was timely also because it came on the eve of Purim.

Purim commemorates the miraculous escape of our people from complete annihilation (Talmud Babli, Megillah 11a) during the time when Persia was the world power. We celebrate this festival by reading the Megillah, wherein the historical event is recorded, and also by sending Mishloach Monoth - food or drink ready to be consumed - and gifts to the poor, so that every one may rejoice with the happy Purim festival. Thus we see that there are two kinds of material assistance: relief to the poor and needy, and also to those who are not really in need of anything, except that they may not have anything ready, and would therefore have to go and buy and cook, before being able to celebrate Purim.

If such consideration is required in regard to material assistance, how much more so with regard to rendering spiritual aid. Here, too, there are two kinds of recipients: the spiritually poor and devoid of knowledge, and the spiritually rich, but only potentially so. In other words, those who have, and those who have not the mental faculties. We must render spiritual aid not merely to those who are spiritually poor, but also to those who are spiritually rich, but have not yet absorbed all the

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necessary knowledge. If we can save the latter time and effort by giving them something 'ready', it is a great Mitzvah.

I need hardly say that your generous assistance to the Merkos L'Inyonel Chinuch goes a long way in providing the vital spiritual food for our Jewish boys and girls.

I am looking forward to our early conference when the affairs and plans of the Merkos will be discussed in detail. We are now awaiting the financial audit by our accountant. However, in view of the fact that the accountant is now busy with Income Tax returns, and would not have the audit for about two weeks, you may wish to have a meeting before that time. If so, please let me know.

With kindest personal regards,

Very sincerely yours,

Rabbi Mendel Schneerson  
Chairman, Exco. Committee

Enc.

May 14, 1945

Mr. Julius Stulman

Dear Mr. Stulman:

This is to acknowledge receipt of your letter, enclosing check for \$ for the Merkos L'Inyonei Chinuch, for which please accept the grateful appreciation of the Merkos L'Inyonei and my own.

Our sages say (Kedushin 40a), "a meritorious deed bears fruit", the deeper meaning of which may be explained as follows:

When a man does a mitzvah - an act of virtue - he does something constructive, either creating something new in the world, or at least helping to bring out something that exists in potentia. The analogy may be found in the man sowing a seed, whereby he causes the productivity that exists in the seed in potentia to take effect. Moreover, the seed produces a tree bearing numerous seeds for further procreation, ad infinitum. Similarly, a good deed contains the seeds of further good deeds, (by creating the atmosphere and conditions for same, etc.) ad infinitum.

Not so in the case of evil doing, which is destructive. And while it is true that "One evil doing drags another" it is not a case of growth or reproduction ad infinitum. The reason is that the very nature of good, like G-d the source of good, is infinite. An evil deed, on the other hand, will be stopped and annulled by the perpetrator himself - through repentance - or by others, for eventually good must triumph over evil, "and G-d shall be king over all the earth".

The infinite effect in the case of meritorious deeds is especially evident in the case of education, for when children are brought up as worthy human beings, both for G-d and man, the good influence they exercise on their environment, and their subsequent part in the education of their own children, perpetuates the original good deed, ad infinitum. That is why the proper education and up-

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bringing of even a single child is tantamount to the building of a whole world.

It should be remembered, however, that moral education which is not based on religion, does not in itself answer the need, and science can in no way replace religion (as has been illustrated all too well in the case of Germany, where science and philosophy had attained the highest levels, and nevertheless, the Germans have perpetrated the most inhuman acts of barbarism). In other words, we cannot be sure of the observance of the commandments, "thou shalt not murder", "thou shalt not steal", etc., unless they are preceded by and based on the teachings of the commandment, "I am G-d thy G-d". This indeed, is one of the most fundamental lessons of Shavuoth, the festival of the Giving of our Torah,

*which we have just celebrated.*

I trust that the above lines will not merely bring out the everlasting good which your generous cooperation is producing, but also the deep appreciation which the Merkos L'Inyonel Chinuch feels in receiving this timely and much needed help.

With kindest regards and best Shavuot greetings, I am

Very sincerely yours,

Rabbi Mendel Schneerson  
Chairman, Exec. Committee

MS:HK  
Enc.

P.S. Enclosed is a statement by our accountant. Enclosed are also copies of our latest publication - Shaloh, of which the first four issues have appeared so far.

Nissan 13, 1946  
April 14, 1946

Mr. Julius Stulman,

My dear Mr. Stulman:

On the occasion of your forthcoming birthday on the second day of Pesach (Nissan 16, corresponding to April 11, 1946), I take great pleasure in extending to you in behalf of the Merkos L'Inyonei Chinuch and in my own name, our heartfelt blessings for your and your family's welfare and happiness, spiritual and material.

There is a special Mitzvah connected with the day on which you were born which, during the time when the Beth Hamikdash was in existence in Jerusalem, was carried out in deed, but which is now carried out in spirit only. This special Mitzvah is the Mitzvah of the "omer" - a certain measure of the newly harvested barley crop brought to the Beth Hamikdash as a thanksgiving offering on behalf of all the people of Israel. It was only after this offering had been brought to the Beth Hamikdash that the new harvest was permitted to be enjoyed by all the people. (This is the only occasion when an offering of barley was made on behalf of all the people).

The significance of this Mitzvah may be briefly outlined as follows:

Barley is primarily a crop used for fodder (unlike wheat which is the staple crop used for human food). In the spring month of Nissan, the month of the barley harvest (in Palestine and surrounding lands), when nature seemingly comes back to life with all its physical forces, we Jews celebrate our Festival of Liberation from physical bondage. Significantly, this celebration is followed immediately on the second day by the Mitzvah of the "Omer". This gesture means the following: We know that we have two souls within us, the "animal" soul and the "divine" soul. But before we allow our

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physical body and "animal" soul to enjoy the new harvest (all material things), we offer the first Omer as a thanksgiving to G-d. This is not merely an expression of gratitude, but also an indication of our realization that G-d has first claim upon our material possessions. The fact that the "Omer" was a small measure goes to show quantity is not always of primary importance here, but rather the spirit and joy that lie behind the fulfillment of this Mitzvah.

As for the reward of this Mitzvah, our Sages have said: "Pesach is the time of the harvest; said G-d to Israel, 'Bring Me one Omer of Pesach so that your crops in the field may be blessed.'" So we see that G-d's blessing is immeasurably greater than the little sacrifice which we are asked to bring by the fulfillment of G-d's command.

On your birthday, the day of the bringing of the Omer, I wish you that the significance of this unique Mitzvah and its reward find expression in your daily life in full measure, both spiritually and materially.

Wishing you and yours a kosher and happy Passover,

I remain,

Very sincerely yours,

Rabbi Mendel Schneerson  
Chairman, Executive Committee

RMSbk

Sivan 4, 5706  
June 3, 1946

Mr. Julius Stulman

Dear Mr. Stulman:

You have been very generous to the Merkos L'Inyonei Chinuch, and I do not have to tell you that you are the main pillar of support of our work. You were kind enough, moreover, to leave the door open for future approach to you in the time of need. This is such a time, for the Merkos L'Inyonei Chinuch which will find itself hard pressed for funds in the next couple of weeks. So I take the liberty to approach you again. I trust that without continuing to elaborate on the needs of the Merkos L'Inyonei Chinuch, so well known to you, you will once again be dictated by your soul, mind and heart to extend to the Merkos L'Inyonei Chinuch your helping hand.

On the occasion of the approaching festival of Shavuoth I wish you and yours, on behalf of the Merkos L'Inyonei Chinuch and myself, a very happy and inspiring Yom Tov.

Shavuoth - the festival commemorating the giving of the Torah on Mt. Sinai 3258 years ago - is a most opportune moment to reflect upon the divine beauty of our religion. The very Decalogue revealed on Mt. Sinai on that day reflects the beauty and depth of our faith which gave the world the truth of monotheism and the ideals of freedom, justice, honesty and brotherhood.

The divine proclamation of monotheism in a world full of idolatry (which has essentially changed but little, since people still worship many "gods," whether they be their passions for bodily pleasure, riches, honor or power) contained in the opening Commandments has been amply expanded by our great Jewish thinkers, Cabbalists and philosophers of all ages, down to our present day Chassidic doctrine.



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But the Ten Commandments are not confined to abstract metaphysics. They go on with "Thou shalt not murder!" "Thou shalt not steal!" "Thou shalt not covet!" Here we see the profound difference between the Jewish religion and all others. For our religion is not a religion of dogma alone, of "believe and be saved." Our religion underscores the indispensability of good deeds in daily life, and such was the reaction of our people in those days: "Na'Aseh V'nishma" - we will do and obey. Our religion embraces man's entire life, so that even in his daily life, in his associations with fellow man, in his business and work, he must give full expression to all the commandments of the Torah, so that his soul and body be attuned to the Divine call first sounded on Mt. Sinai.

With kindest personal regards and Good Yomtov, I remain

Very Sincerely yours,

MS:BK

Rabbi Mendel Schneerson  
Chairman, Exec. Committee